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Dison gets permit to dump effluent

VICTORIA (CP) — Dison Development Ltd. of Vancouver has been granted a permit to discharge up to a million gallons of effluent a day from the Sunro mine, near Jordan River, into Juan de Fuca Strait.

But in issuing the permit Monday William Venables, the provincial director of pollution control, imposed conditions in the form of stiff new controls.

Among these is the stipulation that tailings be discharged at a depth of 40 feet below the lowest tide line, which would require a discharge pipe extending about 1,500 feet into the strait.

The company had earlier proposed that the end of the pipe be just below the surface at lowest tide.

Other conditions require Dison to:

—Pay for an independent firm to monitor the tailings and report directly to the pollution control branch, which would first approve the choice of firm;

—Build an emergency spill basin and also launch a sampling and surveillance program before it starts mining;

—Post $12,000 in security with the pollution control branch within six months or before it starts operations; — Insure that tailings are not more than 25 per cent solids, and that the traces of copper, lead, zinc, chromium, cadium and silver they contain do not together total more than one part per million.

After Venables rejected a permit application by the company June 1, Dison appealed to the pollution control board. Following a public hearing June 30 the board upheld the appeal because it said the company had shown a willingness to improve pollution control measures.

The board instructed Venables to issue a discharge permit but to include all the standards and controls he felt necessary.

Company officers were studying the conditions Tuesday.

Residents at Jordan River have argued that tailings from the mine polluted beaches, fishermen have said the cloudy waters produced would hurt fishing and both health and recreation officials within the provincial government argued against the mine at the appeal hearing.

West Berlin has a population of 2,125,000.

4 ESCAPEES RECAPTURED

PORT COQUITLAM — Four men transferred from prison to Riverview mental hospital and considered dangerous, were recaptured early today after fleeing from the Colony Farm maximum security unit.

Two of the men, identified as Roy G. Shirey, 24, and Norman Trudel, 23, were caught by police in Haney after a high speed car chase. The men stole a car in Port Coquitlam and were captured when the car failed to make a curve on the Lougheed highway at 3 a.m.

John Cathcart, 37, was picked up in downtown Port Coquitlam about 4 a.m.

Abraham Bill, 29, was found by police walking along a railway track in Port Coquitlam shortly before 8 a.m.

Indian chief shot with Mountie gun

YELLOWKNIFE, N.WT. (CP) — RCMP said Monday night that Edd Bird, 32, secretary-treasurer of the Northwest Territories Indian Brotherhood, was shot with a police service revolver.

Bird was in serious condition in Yellowknife hospital with bullet wounds to the chest and leg. He was shot early Friday morning at the trailer court where he lives.

Insp. Hugh Feagan of the RCMP said Bird was shot during an incident which arose when police went to investigate a complaint at the trailer court.

Bird, chief of the Fort Smith, N.W.T., Indian band, underwent surgery for the chest wound.

Gerald Sutton, lawyer for the brotherhood, said that from the facts so far there did not appear to be any "impropriety" on the part of the police.

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